chapter focuses on the HTTP server you need to expose your `ActorSystem`.

NOTE The source code for this chapter is available at www.manning.com/books/akka-in-action-second-edition or https://github.com/franciscolopez sancho/akka-topics/tree/main/chapter11a. You can find the contents of any snippet or listing in the .scala file with the same name as the class, object, or trait.

11.1.1 Akka HTTP servers

An Akka HTTP server is nothing more than a process that listens for HTTP requests on a port and generates responses. An `ActorSystem` maintains this process. Let's cover the basic primitives of Akka HTTP:

- Path
- Routes
- Directives
- Marshalling/unmarshalling

In the first simple scenario, you have a server that accepts requests on the path /ping and responds with "pong":

```
$ curl localhost:8080/ping
pong
```

11.1.2 The path